

Unless the information you enter is formatted as a value or as a formula, Excel will interpret it as a label, and defaults to align any text on the left side of the cell.

If you are creating a long worksheet and you will be repeating the same label information in many different cells, you can use the 'AutoComplete' function. This function will look at other entries in the same column and attempt to match a previous entry with your current entry. For example, if you have already typed 'House' in another cell and you type 'H' in a new cell, Excel will automatically enter 'House'. If you intended to type 'House' into the cell, your task is done, and you can move on to the next cell. If you intended to type something else, e.g. 'Hearth', into the cell, just continue typing to enter the term.

To turn on the 'AutoComplete function', go to **Tools > Options > Edit**, and click to put a check in the box beside 'Enable AutoComplete for cell values.'

Another way to quickly enter repeated labels is to use the 'Pick List' feature. Right click on a cell, then select 'Pick From List.' This will give you a menu of all other entries in cells in that column. Click on an item in the menu to enter it into the currently selected cell.

A value is a number, date, or time, plus a few symbols if necessary to further define the numbers (such as : . , + - () % \$ /).

Numbers are assumed to be positive; to enter a negative number, use a minus sign, or enclose the number in parentheses.

Dates are stored as MM/DD/YYYY, but you do not have to enter it precisely in that format. First off, you can change it to reflect Indian (UK) usage, as DD/MM/YYYY; do this by formatting the cells that contain your dates. Select the cell(s), then go to **Format > Cells**, and in the 'Number' tab, click 'Date'. Here, under the 'Locale' drop-down menu, select 'English (United Kingdom)'. Alternatively, you can go to the **Control Panel > Regional And**